MONTHLY UPDATE

AI: monthly update, September – October 2026

Edition of 2026-10-12 · compiled by Claude Opus from the documents in the Corpus repository

> *35 places. Every block below is carried verbatim from that place's own monthly update, where it was written, sourced and checked; nothing is written here.*

ALGERIA · ANGOLA · BENIN · BOTSWANA · BURKINA FASO · BURUNDI · CHAD · COTE D'IVOIRE · DJIBOUTI · DR CONGO · EGYPT · ESWATINI · GABON · GHANA · KENYA · LESOTHO · MALAWI · MALI · MAURITANIA · MAURITIUS · MOROCCO · NAMIBIA · NIGERIA · RWANDA · SENEGAL · SEYCHELLES · SIERRA LEONE · SOMALIA · SOUTH AFRICA · TANZANIA · TOGO · TUNISIA · UGANDA · ZAMBIA · ZIMBABWE

The place reports do not share one window; the period above is the range they span.

Algeria

Implementation of the national strategy is organised under the higher-education minister. A second meeting on 8 September created five thematic commissions, a national AI and data research centre, short-term projects for AI-based tax administration and a multisectoral AI system, and a target of 50,000 AI specialists by 2030. The strategy text is still not published and the ethical-AI law has not moved.

A follow-up meeting on the strategy, reported on 22 September, approved an updated draft decree creating a national AI and data research centre and set 17 infrastructure and 14 data operations for 2026. The decree is in legal procedure and the strategy text remains unpublished.

Angola

Money reached artificial intelligence in the administration for the first time this month, ahead of any policy saying what it is for. A presidential order of 27 August authorised six million United States dollars for the acquisition and implementation of an artificial-intelligence platform for the public administration and opened a public tender for it. What the platform is to do, which bodies would use it and on what data are not stated, and the repository holds no national instrument on artificial intelligence in government against which to read the spend.

Benin

The health ministry awarded a contract for 20 AI-assisted malaria diagnosis units for public referral hospitals to the South Korean firm Noul, reported on 8 September. A state project has collected 700 hours of Fongbe audio from 2,400 contributors to build AI training material in Beninese languages; the account asks what happens to the recordings afterwards. The national machine-learning meeting at Cotonou on 10 to 12 September opened a track on African-language models. The digital agency's quarterly bulletin called for AI-specific rules on governance, liability and compliance, naming no legal vehicle or timetable. An external policy assessment argued that Benin must convert its lead in artificial-intelligence governance into results, with the national strategy in force.

Botswana

A US company announced on 15 September that its AI clinical decision-support platform will be extended to Botswana through the Botswana-UPenn Partnership, with a customised tool to be built with local clinicians. No timetable, site count or cost is stated.

Burkina Faso

Camera enforcement of road offences recorded 19,910 offences over August 2026, with CFA146.559m in fines issued and CFA16.1m recovered, reported on 7 September.

Burundi

The strategy went looking for money. The finance and budget minister carried its ambitions to the Korea-Africa economic cooperation ministerial in Seoul, seeking the financing and partnerships to turn it into concrete projects, the account naming connectivity, data infrastructure and local skills as what the strategy validated in April provides for, against national digital capacity it describes as limited. No commitment, partner or project is reported as resulting, which leaves the strategy where the repository already had it: adopted, unfunded and unimplemented.

Chad

A pre-validation workshop for the National Artificial Intelligence Strategy opened in N'Djamena on 8 October 2026, the strategy aimed at health, agriculture, education and public services.

Cote d'Ivoire

The national AI conference ended with a list and a deadline: 77 priority use cases selected from hundreds, and a national roadmap for them to be finalised within three weeks. The state signed a voluntary national AI pact with the employers' confederation and the chamber of commerce, with no legal or financial obligation attached.

A Swiss-founded research centre in Côte d'Ivoire is one of four African partners in a four-year, GBP 4.4m Wellcome Trust programme led by the University of Cape Town, pairing open-source microscopes with machine-learning image analysis for infectious-disease research, which began in September.

Djibouti

The national strategy in preparation since January was presented. The ministry convened cross-ministerial focal points on 15 August to prepare the country's first national artificial-intelligence forum, which opened at the Palais du Peuple on the morning of 2 September under the President's patronage. On 3 September the strategy's main lines were presented for 2026 to 2030 on six axes - data and AI governance, cybersecurity, training, research, innovation and inclusion. Its text is not published.

The readiness assessment presented with it, run on UNESCO's methodology, rates the country emerging, at about 24.5 out of 100 on AI readiness against an ICT development index of 61.6, and finds no law dealing specifically with artificial intelligence. The report itself is not held.

The forum also carried a first national AI prototyping competition, putting young Djiboutians' projects in front of it. No entrant count, prize or follow-on support is published.

DR Congo

The digital economy ministry announced in a communiqué of 22 September that Anthropic's Claude is officially available in the country, for Claude.ai and commercial API access, citing approaches it had made to the company. No terms were given. A private survey of 2,280 adults in the 26 provincial capitals found 61% aware of artificial intelligence in March 2026, against 54% a year earlier.

Egypt

On 8 September the communications minister attended a Cairo ceremony at which Vodafone Business, Elsewedy Electric and Cassava Technologies undertook to establish Africa Data Centres Egypt and the country's first sovereign artificial-intelligence data centre, the state framing both as localising advanced technology and hosting and processing data domestically. No site, date or capacity for the AI centre is stated.

The cabinet information centre put those who had heard of artificial-intelligence applications at 65% in 2026 against 22% in 2023, work the leading use at 51.7% ahead of personal use and study, with about 94% of users rating the accuracy of the answers they get. Sample size, method and margin are not stated.

The national AI council adopted the strategy's achievements report for the first half of 2026, reviewed the outlines of a National Quantum Computing Strategy 2027-2030, and covered government procurement guidelines for AI systems, generative-AI guidelines for government and Safe Use Guidelines for AI Applications for Children, reported on 25 September. None of the guidelines is stated as adopted or published. A newspaper reported that Egypt led the Human Rights Council to adopt by consensus a resolution on artificial intelligence and human rights.

Eswatini

No national AI strategy or statute stands behind either, though on 16 September the ICT minister said a consultant has been engaged to draft a strategy.

The audit office took its own artificial-intelligence commitment regional, hosting a week-long peer programme at which supreme audit institutions across the region weighed the use of artificial intelligence in government audit. As with the strategic plan in August, no tool, pilot, audit methodology or procurement is named — what the repository holds is the intention and the forum it was stated in.

The revenue service said at the opening of the 2026 filing season that three technology providers, one a young local firm, are being integrated into its TaxCore electronic invoicing system, to which businesses' accounting and point-of-sale systems must connect.

Gabon

No national AI strategy or policy is adopted. Preparatory work for one closed in Libreville on 30 September 2026 with 22 challenges and 36 recommendations from six working groups supported by the UN development programme.

Ghana

Two applied systems launched outside government. The development bank's AI platform gives farmers agronomic guidance and loan officers portfolio intelligence on a messaging app, after a pilot of more than 8,500 queries in three months, and a non-profit with the dominant operator opened a toll-free voice line answering in six languages, an AI system included, for callers without data.

Two automated systems reported. The police set 1 October 2026 for full automated traffic enforcement, with camera-captured offences reviewed before notices go out by SMS and fines paid through Ghana.gov within 14 days, after a pilot that issued about 120,000 caution notices. The revenue authority put customs collections at up to US$450m a month against about US$350m before its AI valuation system, its own figure and higher than the finance ministry's monthly series.

Two disability systems came out of one university. Researchers at the Kwame Nkrumah University of Science and Technology presented SignTalk-Gh, a working model that translates Ghanaian Sign Language to text and audio and back for doctor-patient consultations, not yet deployed in any hospital, and its Responsible AI Lab now hosts a continental Hub for AI and Disability Inclusion, launched with a network for finding disability datasets and a first-year inventory of them. A commentator's account puts the start of fining under the automated traffic system back a month, to 1 November, after complaints of poor sensitisation.

The central bank's governor said a directive on the use of artificial intelligence in the financial sector is in drafting; no draft or date is published.

Kenya

A model provider disclosed that it had removed a domestic actor's account mass-producing posts in batches of 50, praising the energy minister's tariff decision and claiming the opposition was fracturing ahead of 2027, with no reach established; the minister denied any ministry role. The state's own compute moved a step: a Letter of Agreement with the UN development agency commits to operationalising sovereign AI infrastructure at the Konza Data Centre, and the Treasury describes the Konza Digital Media City as recently approved for Korean financing.

The Kenya Medical Research Institute is a partner in openScopes AIDDiA, a four-year, GBP 4.4m Wellcome Trust-funded programme led by the University of Cape Town that pairs open-source microscopes with machine-learning image analysis for infectious-disease research, which held its kick-off from 7 to 11 September.

At the UN General Assembly Kenya co-hosted the launch of a 2026-2027 roadmap for children's rights and protection in the age of AI, backed by 23 states and eight UN entities; no national instrument implements it. In Nairobi a pan-African hub and data network for disability-inclusive AI was launched with Maseno University's applied AI centre among its partners, and the same centre began onboarding Dholuo speakers for a speech dataset. The central bank published its March 2025 survey on 22 September: half of surveyed institutions had adopted AI, 30 per cent held a formal AI strategy and credit risk assessment was the leading use, at 65 per cent of adopters.

Lesotho

At the second UN Digital Cooperation Day the prime minister said Lesotho was the first country to implement the UN AI Blueprint, that planning was complete and that Phase One of a National Compute Roadmap running 2026 to 2029 had begun (23 September). The roadmap is not published, and no source relates it to the data-centre roadmap drafted in August.

Malawi

The regulator recommended an AI camera network to Blantyre's city assembly, reported on 28 September: intelligent cameras, number-plate recognition and a central command centre, first at four sites, with no cost, supplier or timeline published. UNDP published lessons on 17 September from AI compute it has installed with public institutions in six countries, Malawi among them; a farmer advisory service is held back by incomplete soil and disease data.

Mali

The transition president inaugurated a centre for artificial intelligence and robotics on 21 September 2026 on a 50-hectare site at Kati Sirakoro Niare, with teaching facilities, dormitories and a fabrication and assembly workshop, financed from the national budget at FCFA 3.3bn.

Mauritania

The month's artificial-intelligence record is a training room. The national meteorological authority ran a two-day workshop in Nouakchott from 8 September for regional administrators and its own staff on an AI-based agricultural, hydrological and meteorological early warning system, to strengthen national capacity to forecast climate risks and reduce their effects on agriculture and water resources, and to equip regional staff to use AI techniques in processing and analysing meteorological data. Training on a platform is not the platform in service: no coverage, forecast product, accuracy measure, funder or operational start date is published.

Mauritius

A junior finance minister announced the creation of an AI City to an international convention on 12 September. No site, investor, capacity or date accompanies the announcement.

Morocco

The AI roadmap was presented as moving to delivery on 8 September. The ministry set targets of MAD 100bn in value added, 50,000 jobs and 200,000 certified talents by 2030, showed a sovereign AI marketplace, an assistant on the administrative-procedures portal and a national e-wallet proof of concept, and the four JAZARI institutes held general assemblies and moved to operations. The roadmap document is still not published.

On 30 September the digital ministry and Mistral announced a Darija dialect classifier and a Darija speech-recognition model as the first open-source tools of their partnership, saying further generative-AI and public-service models are in development. The release does not say when the tools become available, and no terms, cost or data-hosting arrangement of the partnership is published.

The national rail operator tendered a MAD 1.08 million study to design a national video-surveillance system with AI analytics and central supervision by 2030, reported on 10 September; no overall budget or deployment timetable is announced.

Namibia

The research commission set the launch of a national artificial-intelligence institute for 23 September, with four centres, one of them curating Namibian datasets, and a youth fellowship it says already reaches about 2,000 tertiary students. It was launched in Windhoek on 23 September, and a working group has submitted its first report on a planned national dataset; no budget is stated.

Nigeria

On 24 September the electoral commission's chairman said it had begun deploying AI checks inside results management to flag discrepancies before final validation, each subject to human audit, under a new AI Division and an AI Roadmap and Governance Framework, four months before the 2027 general elections. The framework text is

not held. The technology agency published an advisory warning against entering identity numbers, bank details or confidential data into public AI tools. An opposition movement called on the electoral commission to abandon AI verification of results until its governance framework is published.

Rwanda

An agriculture official set out a plan to reach 2.5 million farmers with AI advisory services, reported on 2 September, with a Kinyarwanda voice assistant being tested through the ministry's call centre. A regional forum in Kigali on 7 September considered how higher-education quality assurance should change as AI spreads. A UNDP review records country-hosted AI compute deployed under its regional programme, with no national or local-language model named. The statistics institute's labour force survey team built a model that assigns classification codes to survey responses given in Kinyarwanda, English or French, coding 96 per cent of records automatically in one test run; an application for enumerators is not yet in field use.

Senegal

An outside score placed the country: Oxford Insights' 2025 index put government AI readiness at 46.10, 97th in the world and first of the eight UEMOA states. A high court began piloting a locally deployed AI application for judicial archives, with UNDP and Korean funding. The justice ministry judged the pilot's first results satisfactory at a meeting with the UN agency on 9 October 2026, naming staff recruitment and the regular feeding of the court platform as the open challenges.

Seychelles

The tourism minister told a forum on 1 October that its discussions are to feed a Seychelles Tourism Digital and AI Agenda, with the tourism department to follow up; no text or timetable is stated.

Sierra Leone

The information minister launched a national campaign against deepfakes and digital misinformation in Freetown on 16 September 2026, in two phases across all 16 districts. The national security office warned of risks from artificial intelligence in the 2028 elections, as the electoral commission considers using it. The judiciary and the attorney-general's office are to draft a national AI roadmap for the justice sector with UNESCO, starting with the security sector; no timetable is published.

Somalia

Ownership was stated as the goal rather than capability. A senior government adviser told a food-systems forum panel in Kigali that the disaster management agency is building systems so that government holds full ownership of disaster data. No system, agreement or transition plan away from partner-held data is named, so what is recorded is an intention about custody — which is the question the early-warning platform's own arrangements leave open.

South Africa

On 22 September the same bank announced a responsible-AI framework written with Stellenbosch University's data-science school, setting life-cycle rules for human oversight and accountability. It is voluntary, and no audit or enforcement mechanism is stated.

The University of Cape Town began a four-year, GBP 4.4m (about R101m) Wellcome Trust programme with partners in Kenya, Uganda and Côte d'Ivoire, pairing open-source microscopes with machine-learning image analysis for infectious-disease research.

Provincial police warned that creating and sharing artificial-intelligence face-swap images of oneself in police uniform can breach section 68 of the South African Police Service Act 68 of 1995, which makes impersonating a police official an offence. No case or charge has been reported.

A market forecast says 80% of governments will use artificial-intelligence agents by 2028, and that the revenue service is exploring digital twins in tax processing. At a first summit on youth, artificial intelligence and the future of work, a deputy minister described inclusion as connection, capability and command — the third meaning who builds and shapes the technology, not only who can reach it. Neither statement comes with a programme, budget or date.

The state airports company set a five-year plan to 2031 to use AI in check-in, security, baggage handling and parking, with terminal patrol robots and a metaverse proof of concept in the first year, tied to a R21.7bn capital pipeline that also covers wider infrastructure modernisation. The pipeline is not broken down.

The financial conduct regulator's 2025/26 integrated report, presented to Parliament's finance committee in the last week of September, states that a framework for the regulator's own responsible use of AI is being developed, the one outstanding item under its principle on data and technology governance. No publication date is given. A consultancy partner said half of 903 South Africans surveyed had bypassed an employer's restrictions on AI tools. A UNDP programme reported GPU capacity procured, installed and activated with public institutions in six countries, the higher-specification training capacity concentrated in Kenya and South Africa. Its South African use case, crop observation from satellite and research data, waits on access to data held across institutions; no capacity figure or host is stated. The content regulator has approved a digitisation and AI strategy and plans to explore generative AI for monitoring, classification and case management over three to five years; none of it is yet in use. The largest mobile operator says it uses artificial intelligence for revenue assurance, detecting traffic tunnelled through zero-rated sites. No leakage or recovery figure is published. The service published its own account of the programme for the first time: a commissioner's keynote put trust, institutional capability, modernisation and stakeholder partnership at the centre of compliance strategy. No delivery date, budget or system scope is stated, so what is held is a strategy statement and not a delivery position.

Tanzania

The only movement on machine-generated content is in the argument rather than the rule. Technology, academic and creative voices backed digital watermarking of machine-generated content as a way to restore accountability and discourage over-reliance on the tools, following the European transparency duties that took effect on 2 August 2026. No domestic proposal, consultation or instrument follows from it, against online content rules that already prohibit such content outright.

A month later the rules existed. On 31 August the e-Government Authority's board approved standards and guidelines for AI in public institutions, binding every institution and every AI system it runs, requiring impact and risk assessments and prohibiting fully automated decisions with significant outcomes. They are a standard under the e-government statute, not a law, and the national strategy text is still not public.

On a study visit to Helsinki reported on 29 September, the ICT Commission's head of ICT development said the National AI Strategic Framework 2026-2031 is awaiting approval, and that the commission proposes a national readiness and compute-demand assessment feeding a planned AI observatory. No text of the framework is published. The state power utility launched an AI-powered customer channel and a portal for large customers.

Togo

The United Nations Development Programme's country office sought an international consultant to draft a regional guidance note on the governance of artificial-intelligence infrastructure, for a mission running September 2026 to January 2027. Which region it covers, who it is for and what standing it will have are not stated. The local-language AI pilot opened paid public contributions of voice and text with UNDP support. A public-service assistant reachable by web, mobile and voice was strongly prioritised among uses for country-hosted compute, owned by the digital ministry with the state digital agency and the AI laboratory, its procedures and data still to be prepared. No build or date is stated.

Tunisia

At a finance-ministry seminar on 29 September the director general of the national customs school listed a customs risk-targeting system, Sanad 2, and a chatbot for the tax directorate among projects to be announced. Customs presented a simulated risk model on 2025 data that found about 96.9 million dinars in additional amounts at a 49.23% detection rate, and the ministry's computing centre put a one-year big-data tax-audit project, on local infrastructure and open-source tools, at the bid-receipt stage. None has a go-live date on record. A finance ministry document on the 2027 budget rested resource mobilisation on countering tax evasion with artificial intelligence. Customs said the share of declarations sent to the red channel fell from 4.7% in 2025 to 2.6% in 2026, with artificial intelligence in the risk analysis since May. Customs said on 9 October 2026 that artificial intelligence integrated into its risk-management and selectivity system, built in-house, should enter operation at the end of November 2026.

Uganda

A domestic model reached a continental prize rather than a deployment: a startup building credit scoring for smallholder farmers who lack collateral took US$50,000, about 190m shillings, in growth funding at a Kigali food-systems summit. No user count, lender partnership, loan volume or model documentation is published. In the same week the state set artificial intelligence against a sector rather than a system, making "Digital Agenda and Artificial Intelligence to Redesign Tourism" the theme of national World Tourism Day celebrations, against 793,815 visitors in the first half of 2026 and receipts up 25.6% to 2.30tn shillings — a framing with no programme, budget or system behind it.

Mbarara University of Science and Technology leads the data-pipeline and machine-learning work in a four-year, GBP 4.4m Wellcome Trust microscopy programme led by the University of Cape Town, which began in September 2026. The civil aviation authority has moved Entebbe airport's car parks onto AI-assisted number-plate recognition and mobile-money payment, reported 9 October 2026, and says it keeps vehicle registration records, timestamps and payment logs indefinitely, releasing them to security agencies under statutory guidelines.

Zambia

UNDP published lessons on 17 September from AI compute it has installed with public institutions in six countries, Zambia among them. The lead use here is AI analysis of critical-minerals data with the mines ministry and the environmental agency, with data access still to be confirmed.

The technology ministry is piloting Njila.ai, an artificial-intelligence career-guidance platform in the technical and vocational training system under a World Bank-backed skills project, expected to reach more than 17,000 young people.

Zimbabwe

The first indigenous-language models in service are commercial rather than national. The dominant operator's artificial-intelligence subsidiary is phasing in a Ndebele-speaking customer-support assistant from September, trained on thousands of hours of recorded Ndebele speech, alongside a Shona assistant it says already resolves more than 70% of enquiries. The resolution rate is the operator's own, and no dataset, evaluation, error rate or escalation route is published. What matters for the record is where the corpora sit: outside the indigenous-language programme the state has committed to and whose ring-fenced share is still unstated.

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